ProofSlate X Indian Institute Of Technology Kharagpur

Outreach Course Network (OCN)

Brand Usage & Communications Guidelines for Partners

Issued by ProofSlate

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These Guidelines are binding. Compliance is a condition of the Partner's brand licence. Any use of IIT Kharagpur's marks not expressly permitted here, or not pre-approved in writing, is prohibited.

1. Governing Principle

Every communication must represent the relationship **exactly as it is, and no more.** IIT Kharagpur contributes specific micro-specialisation courses delivered through the OCN. It does not award, co-award, validate, accredit, or endorse any degree, diploma, or qualification conferred by a Partner. A learner's relationship with IIT Kharagpur is limited to the OCN micro-specialisation(s) in which the learner is enrolled.

> **The single test:** *"Would a reasonable student or parent, reading or seeing this material, correctly understand that (a) the degree is awarded entirely by the Partner; (b) IIT Kharagpur's involvement is limited to specific micro-specialisation courses; and (c) the Partner is not an IIT Kharagpur-affiliated or endorsed institution?"* If the answer is anything other than a clear yes, the material is non-compliant.

2. Describing the Relationship

2.1 Approved descriptions

Partners may describe the relationship only in terms substantially equivalent to the following:

- "[Programme name] includes IIT Kharagpur micro-specialisation course(s) delivered through the IIT Kharagpur Platinum Jubilee Outreach Course Network."
- "[Partner] is an onboarded partner of the IIT Kharagpur Outreach Course Network, via ProofSlate."
- "Students can earn an IIT Kharagpur OCN Micro-Specialisation Certification alongside their [Partner] degree."

2.2 Prohibited representations

The following are strictly prohibited in any channel, in any language, whether stated directly, implied, or suggested through layout, imagery, or adjacency:

- **Degree association —** describing, implying, or visually suggesting that any degree is awarded by, affiliated to, accredited by, or carried out "in association with" IIT Kharagpur. Phrases such as "your degree now carries the IIT Kharagpur advantage," "IIT

Kharagpur-powered degree," "degree transformation" (in any student-facing material), or "B.Tech with IIT Kharagpur" are forbidden.

- **Institutional equivalence —** presenting the Partner and IIT Kharagpur as joint institutions, co-founders of a programme, or a merged offering (e.g., "[Partner] & IIT Kharagpur collaborate to offer…" as a headline).
- **Programme conflation —** listing the Partner's own degree programmes (B.Tech CSE, B.Tech AI & ML, etc.) under an IIT Kharagpur header or banner as if they are IIT Kharagpur offerings. OCN Micro-specialisation courses must always be listed separately from the Partner's degree programmes.
- **Campus, admission, or placement claims —** suggesting IIT Kharagpur admission, campus study, IIT Kharagpur faculty as the Partner's own faculty, or any placement or ranking outcome attributable to IIT Kharagpur.
- **Logo dominance or lock-ups —** using the IIT Kharagpur logo larger than, above, or with greater visual weight than the Partner's own identity, or creating any combined/merged logo lock-up. IIT Kharagpur campus photographs must not be used as the primary or background visual in any material.
- **Unapproved endorsement language —** "endorsed by," "powered by IIT Kharagpur," "an IIT Kharagpur initiative," "IIT Kharagpur partner university," "IIT-quality education at [Partner]," or any wording that frames the Partner's overall institution as an IIT Kharagpur entity.
- **Standalone IIT Kharagpur headlines —** using "IIT Kharagpur" as the dominant headline of any advertisement where the actual offering is the Partner's degree. The Partner's own programme must always be the headline.

3. Credential Language

IIT Kharagpur confers certain credentials on qualifying learners at its sole discretion. Partners must use the **exact approved phrasing** below. Shortened or paraphrased versions are not permitted.

Credential	Approved Phrasing	Not Permitted
Certificate	IIT Kharagpur OCN Micro-Specialisation Certificate upon successful completion	**"IIT KGP certificate"** (without "OCN Micro-Specialisation")
Student ID	IIT Kharagpur OCN Student Identity Card for the programme duration	**"IIT KGP Student ID"** (must include "OCN" and duration)
Email ID	IIT Kharagpur OCN email ID for the programme duration	**"IIT KGP email ID"** (must include duration qualifier and "OCN")
Alumni Status	IIT Kharagpur OCN Alumni Status upon successful completion	**"IIT KGP Alumni"** or **"IIT KGP Alumni Status"** — must always include "OCN"

Partners must not guarantee these credentials. They must be presented as benefits available to qualifying learners, subject to IIT Kharagpur's policies as amended from time to time.

4. Mandatory Disclaimer

4.1 Standard disclaimer

Wherever IIT Kharagpur is named in a learner-facing or promotional context, the following disclaimer must appear legibly in the same material:

IIT Kharagpur provides specific micro-specialisation course(s) to students of this programme through its Outreach Course Network. The degree/programme is awarded solely by [Partner Name]. IIT Kharagpur does not award, co-award, or endorse any degree of [Partner Name]. All IIT Kharagpur credentials (OCN Student Identity Card, institutional email ID, OCN Micro-Specialisation Certificate, and OCN Alumni Status) are subject to IIT Kharagpur's policies and conferred at its sole discretion.

Prominence: The disclaimer must appear in the same field of view as the IIT Kharagpur reference, in a size and contrast that a reader would ordinarily notice. Footnote-only or hyperlink-only disclaimers do not satisfy this requirement for advertisements. Minimum 7pt in print.

5. Channel-Specific Requirements

The rules in Sections 1–4 apply universally. The following additional requirements apply to specific channels:

Channel	Requirement
Print & newspaper	The Partner's programme must be the headline. IIT Kharagpur may be referenced only as a micro-specialisation contributor. Co-branding and disclaimer must appear in the same field of view. No IIT Kharagpur campus photographs as the primary visual.
Outdoor / hoardings	No aspirational language ("IIT Kharagpur advantage," "IIT-powered") on outdoor media where disclaimers are not feasible.
Websites & landing pages	OCN Micro-specialisation must have a dedicated section, distinct from the Partner's degree pages. Disclaimer must appear above the fold. No SEO meta tags, keywords, or page titles implying institutional affiliation (e.g., "IIT Kharagpur partner college").
Social media (organic)	Each post referencing IIT Kharagpur must make the OCN micro-specialisation framing clear within the post itself — not only in comments or linked pages.
Paid digital (Meta, Google, etc.)	Ad creative and copy require pre-approval. Targeting that implies IIT Kharagpur admission or degree enrolment is prohibited. Disclaimer must be carried in the creative or primary text.
Email / WhatsApp / SMS	Broadcast templates referencing IIT Kharagpur require pre-approval. Forwarded or learner-generated content does not exempt the Partner from accuracy obligations in its own templates.
Prospectus & brochures	OCN Micro-specialisation must be in a separate section from degree programme listings. Disclaimer must appear wherever IIT Kharagpur is mentioned. Admission forms must not reference IIT Kharagpur in the programme name field.
Press & media	Press releases naming IIT Kharagpur OCN require pre-approval. Spokespersons must not characterise the programme as an IIT Kharagpur degree or affiliation. The approved term is "onboarded partner of IIT Kharagpur OCN"
Education fairs & counselling	Standees, scripts, and counsellor talking points mentioning IIT Kharagpur are marketing materials and require pre-approval. Counsellors must not verbally represent the programme as an IIT Kharagpur degree.
Signage & merchandise	No use of IIT Kharagpur marks on merchandise, building signage, permanent installations, or the Partner's own ID cards without specific written approval.

6. Common Violations

The following illustrate frequently encountered violations. Partners must treat these as a practical checklist:

Violation	Why It's Prohibited
"Your B.Tech can now carry the IIT Kharagpur advantage"	Implies IIT KGP endorses or elevates the Partner's degree. The degree is the Partner's alone.
"[Partner] & IIT Kharagpur collaborate to offer exclusive courses"	Implies a joint venture. There is no direct collaboration. [Partner] is just an onboarded partner for IIT Kharagpur OCN
Listing B.Tech programmes under the IIT KGP header	Makes it appear IIT KGP offers these degree programmes. Only micro-specialisations are IIT KGP offerings.
"IIT KGP Alumni Status" (without "OCN")	Drops the "OCN" qualifier, implying equivalence with IIT KGP's regular alumni. Must always be "IIT Kharagpur OCN Alumni Status."
IIT KGP campus photo as the primary ad visual	Creates an impression of institutional affiliation. The Partner's own campus and identity must be the primary visual.

7. Pre-Approval Process

No material referencing IIT Kharagpur or the OCN may be published, printed, broadcast, or displayed until approved in writing by ProofSlate and IIT Kharagpur (ProofSlate will get a written approval from IIT Kharagpur on behalf of the partner).

- **Submit.** Send draft material (artwork, copy, and intended channel) to ProofSlate at the designated approvals address (via email to founders@proofslate.com) with subject line: "IITKGP_OCN_[Partner Name] at least 7 working days before intended publication.
- **Review.** ProofSlate responds within 7 working days with: Approved / Approved with Modifications / Rejected with Reasons. Approval should be explicit and should be communicated in writing on email.
- **Publish only on approval.** Material may go live only in the exact form approved. Any subsequent edit requires fresh approval.
- **Record.** ProofSlate maintains the approvals register. An approval covers only the specific material and channel submitted.

8. Non-Compliance and Consequences

Non-compliant material must be corrected or withdrawn on notice. Depending on severity and the terms of the applicable agreements, consequences shall include:

- Written direction to take down, recall, or correct the material immediately, including issuing a corrective communication of equivalent prominence in the same channel.
- Suspension of the Partner's brand licence pending cure, in accordance with the applicable Tripartite Letter of Association.
- Escalation by ProofSlate to IIT Kharagpur as a compliance report, which may lead to withdrawal of IIT Kharagpur's confirmations.

- In cases of serious misrepresentation, fraud, or breach of academic integrity, immediate action without a cure period.

Nothing in this Section limits any remedy available to IIT Kharagpur or ProofSlate under the governing agreements or at law.

9. Quick Reference Checklist

Before publishing, verify:	Done?
Is the Partner's branding the primary (largest, most prominent) identity?	□
Are only approved formulations used to describe the partnership?	□
Are micro-specialisation courses listed separately from the Partner's degree programmes?	□
Are all credentials stated in full (including "OCN" qualifiers)?	□
Does the material carry the mandatory disclaimer in the same field of view?	□
Has the material been submitted to and approved in writing by ProofSlate?	□
Would a reasonable parent understand this is the Partner's degree, not IIT KGP's?	□

10. Administration

Single point of contact. ProofSlate is the sole channel for all brand approvals, queries, and submissions. Partners must not approach IIT Kharagpur directly on brand matters.

Updates. IIT Kharagpur may amend these Guidelines. The current version supersedes all earlier versions from its effective date.

Precedence. These Guidelines supplement the Tripartite Letter of Association and the bilateral agreement between ProofSlate and the Partner. In the event of conflict on brand matters, the stricter requirement applies.